

A: An independent investigation of language	Learners should: • introduce a field of interest • identify a research focus • select and apply an appropriate methodology for data collection • apply an appropriate method of linguistic analysis to the data collected • present and analyse their results • suggest possible conclusions • evaluate their investigation • include a bibliography. All learners will be expected to demonstrate the methodology used to conduct their investigation as part of their write-up, and to include some use of quantitative data analysis. The word count for this part of the independent language research is 2000–2500 words, excluding raw data and any appendices. There is no limit to the range of topics appropriate for an independent investigation, and individuality of approach is in the spirit of the specification.	• undertake an independent investigation of language, selecting and applying appropriate methods and techniques systematically • demonstrate knowledge of the language levels and how these can be applied in the chosen context • demonstrate understanding of how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriate and systematically to data. • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources • critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users • demonstrate critical understanding of concepts and issues relevant to their chosen area of language study • analyse how contextual factors and language features shape meaning in their chosen area of study
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